

HOW CAN I KNOW I AM SAVED?

Assurance Without Pretending, Panic, or Empty Confidence

Assurance rests in Christ's finished work and God's promises, is witnessed by the Spirit, and is strengthened by rooted faith, love, obedience, fruit, and endurance.



BIG IDEA

Assurance looks first to Christ and God's promise, then recognizes the Spirit's rooted work.

KEY SCRIPTURE

1 John 5:9-13

ALSO READ

John 10:27-30

MEMORY VERSE

1 JOHN 5:13a

"These things have I written unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God; that ye may know that ye have eternal life..."

MAIN QUESTION

What Gives Real Confidence That I Belong to Christ?

45 MINUTES

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SESSION SNAPSHOT



SESSION GOALS

- Ground assurance in Christ's work and God's testimony.
- Distinguish the foundation from confirming fruit.
- See the Spirit's witness and seal as God's work.
- Answer doubt without panic or automatic reassurance.

A

OPENING ACTIVITY: "WHAT CAN HOLD YOUR CONFIDENCE?"

1

WRITE FOUR FOUNDATIONS (2 MIN)

Write: I remember praying. I was baptized. I feel certain. Christ finished His work and God has promised life in His Son.

2

TEST WHAT CAN CHANGE (2 MIN)

Memories may blur, feelings rise and fall, and religious acts can occur without surrender. Ask which statement rests outside the person's changing experience.

3

ADD THE PRESENT QUESTION (2 MIN)

Assurance is not only looking backward. Ask: Whom am I trusting now? Do I hear Christ's voice and follow Him as the One to whom I belong?

4

DISTINGUISH ROOT AND FRUIT (2 MIN)

Christ and God's promise are the root and ground. The Spirit's witness, continuing faith, love, obedience, and endurance are fruit that confirms rooted life.

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LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not give automatic assurance because a student prayed, was baptized, attends church, feels sincere, or cannot remember unbelief. Do not make doubt proof of lostness or fruit the price of salvation. Return the student to Christ, God's Word, present trust, and the Spirit's rooted work.

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PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Four foundation statements
- Student handouts
- Plan private follow-up

Assurance rests in the Christ who saves, not in the strength of today's feelings.

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B

CORE TEACHING

1

BEGIN WITH GOD'S TESTIMONY CONCERNING HIS SON

1 John 5:9-13

God has given eternal life, and this life is in His Son. Assurance begins outside our changing emotions: Christ has accomplished salvation, and God promises life to those who believe on Him.

EMPHASIZE: The foundation is Christ and God's trustworthy Word.

2

LOOK FOR PRESENT TRUST IN THE LIVING SHEPHERD

John 10:27-30

Jesus describes His sheep as hearing His voice and following Him. Their safety rests in His knowledge, gift, and keeping hands, not in a past moment detached from present reliance.

EMPHASIZE: The believer is held by Christ, not by the strength of his grip.

3

RECEIVE THE SPIRIT'S WITNESS AND SEAL

Rom. 8:14-17

The Spirit marks believers as God's own, bears witness to adoption, and works within them the cry of children toward their Father. This witness is deeper than a constant emotional feeling.

EMPHASIZE: God gives His own Spirit as the pledge of belonging.

4

RECOGNIZE ROOTED LIFE BY ITS FRUIT

1 John 3:18-24

Faith, love, obedience, fruit, and endurance do not purchase salvation. They are the risen life of Christ becoming visible and therefore strengthen confidence that the Word has taken root.

EMPHASIZE: Fruit confirms the root; it never replaces it.

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DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1

Why can't feelings carry the full weight of assurance?

Follow-up: What happens on a spiritually dry day?

2

What does 1 John 5 say God has testified?

Follow-up: Where is eternal life found?

3

How does John 10 describe Christ's sheep?

Follow-up: Who is finally responsible for keeping them?

4

How does the Spirit strengthen assurance?

Follow-up: Why is His seal more than a feeling?

5

How can fruit confirm life without earning it?

Follow-up: Which comes first: root or fruit?

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WEEKLY REFLECTION

Read 1 John 5:9-13. Write what God says He has given and where it is found.

- Whom am I trusting now?
- What rooted fruit of Christ's life is becoming visible?

F

FOUNDATION AND CONFIRMATION

FOUNDATION

Christ's finished work + God's promise

CONFIRMING WITNESSES

The Spirit's witness Continuing faith Love and obedience Rooted fruit and endurance

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PRIVATE CONVERSATION

Listen before answering. Ask whom the student is trusting, whether he has surrendered to Christ, and what presently grounds his confidence. Open Scripture; neither manufacture certainty nor feed panic.

N

LEADER NOTES

- Christ before introspection.
- Promise before feeling.
- Keeping before self-grip.
- Fruit confirms, never purchases.
- Doubt calls for truth, not panic.

Real assurance neither pretends nor panics; it rests in Christ and reads the Spirit's rooted work.